

The Noble Sūtra of Prince Siddhārtha

Arthasiddhi · Toh 351 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྒྱལ་བ་དྲོའི་གཟུགས་ཀྱི་མྱེད།

The Noble Sūtra of Prince Siddhārtha, known in Sanskrit as the Arthasiddhi Sūtra and in Tibetan as Phags pa rgyal bu don grub kyi mdo, is a canonical Buddhist sūtra recounting events centered on the Buddha and his attendant Ānanda. The text opens at Śrāvastī, where the Buddha's sudden smile prompts Ānanda to inquire into its cause, setting the stage for a narrative likely connected to the life and spiritual significance of Prince Siddhārtha. It is Toh 351 in the Kangyur, belonging to the general category of sūtra literature, and appears to have been preceded in the same manuscript volume by a related work called "The Prior Connection of the Golden Hue," suggesting it forms part of a sequence of narratively linked texts. As a sūtra of the Kangyur, it preserves teachings and stories attributed to the historical Buddha, presented within the traditional framework of an account heard and transmitted by Ānanda.

he is praised outright. Thus is completed the work called "The Prior Connection of the Golden Hue."

In the Tibetan language: The Noble Sūtra of Prince Siddhārtha (Skt. Arthasiddhi). The First Section.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove, in the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, together with an innumerable assembly of monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen.

At that time the Blessed One smiled, and from the gateway of his mouth he released rays of light adorned with five colors. The venerable Ānanda rose from his seat, arranged his robe, joined his palms together, and addressed the Blessed One in these words: "In the twenty years that I have been in the service of the Buddha's feet, I have never seen him smile in such a way. Does the Blessed One have in mind buddhas of the past, or those yet to come, or those presently abiding? If not, I beg that the meaning of what he does intend be taught." The Blessed One spoke to Ānanda: "It is not the buddhas of the past, the future, or the present that I have in mind. Rather, recollecting a thing that happened, I have turned my mind to an act of giving performed beyond countless aeons ago in the past.

At that time and in that age, in a land called Yava there arose a king named Kuśala who governed his realm by righteous law and protected a great multitude of beings. That king had four thousand ministers, and he held sovereignty over sixty vassal kings. He possessed eight hundred great cities and five hundred battle-elephants clad in armor. Although the king had twenty thousand queens, he had no son. He made offerings to the fierce gods of the mountains and rivers, and through this a son was granted to the finest of his queens. The king himself carefully attended to that queen's bedding, food, drink, and every other requisite, providing all things choice and excellent. When ten months were complete, a son was born. All twenty thousand queens of the palace, upon hearing that a son had been born, were filled with delight and joy, and milk arose of itself. The prince was therefore given the name Siddhārtha. Four wet-nurses were appointed to nurse and tend the prince: one was appointed to the task of nursing him, one was appointed to carry him in her arms, one was appointed to the task of bathing him, and one was appointed to the task of taking him out to play. So it was appointed.

When the prince reached the age of sixteen, there was nothing in the arts of letters and calculation, archery, craftsmanship, music, or any other field that he did not know — he had mastered them all. He attended upon his father and mother, the king and queen, as though they were divine lords. The king in turn had a separate palace built for the prince.

From childhood the prince delighted in giving, and rejoiced in the happiness and well-being of all sentient beings, from humans down to wild beasts and birds. He even said in words: 'One who is ignorant and does not know, who takes no delight in giving, deceives himself and is without benefit to others. But the wise one endowed with discernment, though living in the world, sees great virtue in giving, and by the giving of gifts will be praised and extolled by all buddhas of the past, the future, and the present — by all pratyekabuddhas and all noble arhats.'

When the prince had grown tall and fine, he took as queen the daughter of a certain king, a girl named Mantī, possessed of excellent physical form and beauty, unrivaled in her loveliness, adorned with ornaments of gold, silver, lapis lazuli, and various precious gems. And so it came to be that there were a son and a daughter.

Then the prince, having turned his mind toward the aim of the perfection of generosity (pāramitā), addressed his father the king, saying, "I wish to go out

for recreation and sightseeing." The king granted this. And so the prince set out from the palace.

Now Śakra, the lord of the gods (Indra, king of the devas), caused to be conjured up and stationed along the streets and gateways of the city various beggars — the blind, the lame, and the mute. When the prince saw them, he turned back at once, entered the palace, and sat weighed down by great sorrow and dejection. His father the king then addressed him, saying, "You were sent out for recreation and sightseeing — why have you returned sorrowful and sad?" The prince answered his father: "When I went out for recreation and sightseeing, I encountered many beggars — blind people, the lame, and the mute — and was overcome with grief. Father, if I were to make one request of you, would the king grant it?" His father the king replied, "Prince, whatever you wish, say it, and it shall be granted."

The prince then spoke to his father the king: "I wish to have the treasures and precious goods that are in the treasury under your majesty's sovereignty piled up at the four city gates and in the marketplace, so that I may give gifts to all beggars freely, without any withholding." The king thereupon told his son, "Whatever you wish, without any withholding, it is granted."

The prince then commanded the ministers, had the wealth, valuables, and precious goods loaded onto carts, piled up at the four city gates and in the marketplace, and distributed them to all who came, freely and without withholding, exactly as each recipient desired. The prince's fame and virtuous qualities spread throughout the lands in all eight directions, and people came from a hundred leagues away, from a thousand leagues away, and from beyond ten thousand leagues. To those who desired food and drink, he gave food and drink. To those who desired clothing and garments, he gave clothing and garments. To those who desired gold, silver, and precious gems, he gave whatever they wished for, freely and without withholding, holding nothing back.

Now at that time there was a rival kingdom. When its king heard that the prince delighted in giving and distributed everything freely to all who sought, without withholding, exactly as they desired, he assembled all his ministers and wise and learned advisors and deliberated, saying: "The king of the Ya kingdom possesses a great elephant of white felt, known as Sudāya, who walks upon a lotus. Whenever we have gone to war against another rival kingdom, this elephant has always brought victory. Can any one of you go

there and procure it?" But none among the ministers was willing to go.

Then eight brahmins from among them addressed the king: "We wish to go as mendicants to beg for it — but provide us with provisions and a stipend for the journey." The king furnished them with provisions and a stipend, and charged those brahmins: "If you bring that white elephant back, I will reward you greatly." Thereupon the eight brahmins took up their staffs and traveled over mountains and passes to the land of Ya, wherever it might be found.

Arriving in that land, they stood at the palace gate, leaning on their staffs, one foot raised, in the posture of mendicant supplication. The prince's gatekeeper went inside the palace and announced that certain brahmins had arrived outside, standing on one foot, leaning on their staffs, and declaring, "We have come from a great distance especially to beg here." When the prince heard this, he was exceedingly delighted. He immediately went outside, greeted them, and paid homage.

Just as a father and son, upon meeting, each speaks to the other with words of warm delight, the prince asked: "From which direction have you come? Was your journey free of hardship? What is it you wish to request?" And he said, "Why do you stand with one foot raised?"

The eight brahmins replied: "O prince, because your joy in giving is so great, you never act contrary to the wishes of any petitioner. This virtue of yours has been proclaimed in all eight directions, reaching as high as the sky above and as low as the depths of the earth below. The virtue of your generosity is inconceivable. It has been praised and proclaimed by all, near and far, so that there is no one who has not heard of it or does not know of it. And nothing that everyone says of you is false. Now that you have become a son of the gods, whatever the gods say is also not false. If the prince were not to give, would he not be acting contrary to our wishes? We have come to you to beg a Nepali elephant that walks upon lotus blossoms."

At these words, the prince led them to the keeper of the Nepali elephants and gave them a different Nepali elephant. But the eight brahmins said: "It is specifically the Nepali elephant that walks upon lotus blossoms that we desire." The prince replied: "This Nepali elephant is dear to my father the king, who has bestowed it upon me. The king considers this elephant and myself to be inseparable, and so it is not right for me to give it to you. If I were to give it to you, it would be contrary to the king's wish, and on account of this elephant I might be banished from this land." Having said this, the prince then thought

to himself: "Previously I had vowed that I would never act contrary to the wishes of any petitioner, whatever they might ask. But now I am turning back from what I resolved before. If I do not give this gift, how could the perfection of generosity, the supreme and equal giving, ever be fulfilled? But if I do give this gift, it will become the awakening mind of supreme and equal generosity."

Thinking thus, the prince spoke these words: "Though it is exceedingly difficult, I shall give it just the same." He then ordered the servant standing nearby to quickly saddle the Nepali elephant with a gold and silver saddle and bring it at once. When the elephant was brought, the prince took a water vessel in his left hand and washed the brahmins' hands, then with his right hand took the Nepali elephant by its lead rope and gave it to the eight brahmins. The eight brahmins then offered aspirational prayers for the prince. The moment they had made these prayers, the Nepali elephant was startled, and it departed joyfully.

The prince then gave the brahmins another instruction: "Go quickly and in haste. If my father the king comes to hear of this, he will send soldiers to come and take it back." At these words, the brahmins immediately departed in great haste.

When the ministers heard that the prince had given the Nepali elephant to an enemy, they were all overcome with alarm and fell headlong from their seats, overwhelmed with grief. They thought: "In this land, when one looks to this elephant, it is now gone, given to the enemy." They went to where the king was and reported: "The prince has given to a foreign enemy the precious Nepali elephant capable of subduing external foes." At this the king, the father, became beside himself with anguish. A minister then reported further: "At present, having this Nepali elephant greatly increases the king's sovereign power. That Nepali elephant possesses the strength and power of some sixty ordinary elephants, and yet the prince has given it away to an enemy."

"If the enemy takes even the kingdom through such begging, what then is to be done? By giving in this manner from his own impulse, the treasury has already been emptied, and we fear he may go on to give away the kingdom, the queen, and even the princes."

When the king heard these words, his displeasure deepened still further. He summoned another minister and asked that minister whether it was true that the prince had given the Nepali elephant to the enemy. The minister confirmed that it was indeed true. The moment the king heard this, he was

seized with great shock and fell from his throne, losing consciousness in a faint. He was revived with water, and after a long while he came back to his senses. All twenty thousand queens likewise were overwhelmed with grief.

Then the king and his ministers assembled to deliberate on what was now to be done with the prince. Among them, one minister put forward his judgment: "The one who went to serve as groom to the Nepali elephant deserves to have his leg cut off. The one who held the elephant deserves to have his arm cut off. Even one who merely looked at the Nepali elephant with his eyes deserves to have those eyes gouged out." Others among the ministers deliberated and offered their counsel separately, saying: "Beheading is what is fitting." When the king heard the words of advice put forward by the ministers, he was deeply displeased and oppressed by grief, and he commanded the ministers thus: "If my son is devoted to the good and is fond of giving, how is he to be restrained and kept in check?"

Then one minister among them, having assessed that the deliberations of the previous ministers were not appropriate, spoke up and said: "Since the king has but this one son, beloved and dear, and the prince is the royal heir, it is not fitting to give rise to the thought of restraining and punishing him. I do not counsel that the great king's son be arrested and punished. Rather, if the prince is driven out of this land and abandoned in a wilderness for twelve years, he will become shamed and disgraced." The king heeded the words of that great minister.

Then the king summoned the crown prince, the royal heir, and spoke to him thus: "Is it true that you gave my Nepali elephant to the enemy?" The prince replied: "I did indeed give it." The king said: "Prince, why did you give my Nepali elephant to the enemy without asking me?" The prince replied to the king: "Previously, when making a vow with the royal father, you declared that whatever I gave away you would not obstruct. It is on that account that I did not ask the king." The king said: "The vow made before granted you authority over wealth, goods, and jewels — what has the Nepali elephant to do with that?" The prince replied: "Since all of those belong to the king's own treasury, why single out this one as excluded?" The king then said to the crown prince, the royal heir: "You shall be banished for twelve years to the Ridanti wilderness. Depart from this land at once."

The prince said to the king: "If I am not to disobey the command of the great king, grant me seven more days so that I may complete my giving, fulfil my

intention, and then depart and go from this land." The king replied: "Because you gave what was not fitting to give, you have emptied the entire treasury of the kingdom and left me without my precious Nepali elephant. It is for this that you are banished. I will not permit you to stay and give for seven days. Go at once." He so commanded.

The prince said: "I will not disobey the great king's command." Then all twenty thousand of the king's queens came to where the king was and petitioned him, saying that the crown prince, the royal heir, be granted seven days to give, and thereafter to depart from the land. The king consented and granted it accordingly.

Then the crown prince, the royal heir, dispatched servants separately in each direction with this proclamation: those who desired wealth and goods from the four directions should gather at the palace gate, for all wealth and possessions are impermanent and unstable — their very nature is to perish and pass away. With this announcement made, great multitudes of supplicants arrived from the four directions, and the crown prince, the royal heir, gave them food and drink, wealth and precious things, just as they wished, for seven days, until all the destitute were provided with prosperity and made happy and at ease.

Then the crown prince, the royal heir, said to his wife: "Fair lady, listen now to what I have to say. The great king has banished me for twelve years to a place called Ridam Tig."

When the princess heard the prince's words, she started up in alarm and spoke these words: "What fault has the prince committed that the king should have done such a thing?" The prince replied: "I gave what was not fitting to give, emptied the king's treasury, and gave the precious Nepali elephant to an enemy. For this the king and his ministers grew angry and banished me."

Princess Mandī said: "May there be good harvests in the king's realm, may there be happiness between the great king, his ministers, and his subjects, may prosperity be great — I make this heartfelt aspiration prayer, and let us go to the mountain for meditation."

The prince said: "Fair lady, the mountain is a place of danger. What lies ahead must be considered with great care. There are ferocious wild beasts — lions, tigers, and the like — and this is a source of deep terror. You are one who has lived in comfort and luxury. Can you endure such things as those? In the palace you wear clothing that is fine and soft; you dwell sheltered by curtains and canopies; for food you eat what is delicious and sweet, just as your taste

desires. On the mountain, dried grass is your seat and fruits are your food. What delight or contentment could you find in that? And beyond that, the wind, the rain, thunder, and hail are violent; the cold and damp make even a person's body hair stand up, and when it is cold it is intensely cold, and when it is hot it is intensely hot. Even sitting in the shade of a tree is no shelter. The ground is full of thorns, sharp gravel, and stones, and there are poisonous serpents. Can you endure such things as these?"

Mandī replied: "What use to me are softness, fine cloth, curtains, canopies, sweet food, and delicious things? To be parted from the prince and go our separate ways — that I cannot bear. I wish always to be inseparable from the prince and to travel at his side. As the banner that leads an army, as smoke that precedes fire, so a wife is foremost of a household; thus I place my trust in the prince and go to him for refuge. The prince is my god. When the prince gave gifts to all who gathered from the four directions, I too stood by him as a companion. Now that the prince is going on a long journey, if supplicants should come from the other side as well, I will likewise be his companion. Even should my own life be at stake, I will not cry out in retreat when the prince performs acts of generosity — so please have no hesitation." The prince replied: "My delight in giving does not turn back the minds of those on the other side, and even should someone come begging for our children or for yourself, I could not refuse to give them. If what I have resolved upon you do not likewise carry out, my virtuous intention would be disturbed, and that would not be right for us to go forward in that way."

Mandī said: "The prince's practice of generosity is unlike anything else in this world — please give just as you wish." The prince said: "If you are able in that way, it is very good indeed."

And so the prince, the princess, and their two children set out together. They went to where the queen mother was, and approaching, they said: "We have come now," and making prostration, they spoke to the queen mother in this way:

From time to time the queen mother had petitioned the great king that through wholesome Dharma the kingdom might be governed in peace and that many subjects might be protected from having their lives cut short. Now, seeing that the prince was about to depart and making prostration, she was overcome with grief and, seated close by, spoke these words:

"This body of mine is as hard as stone, and my heart is as hard as a vajra — for if I had failed in my duties of service to the great king, then why, now that I am parting from this my only son as he goes away, has my heart not shattered and killed me? While this son was within my womb he grew by day and by night like the leaves of a great tree, and now, his birth complete, he has left me and gone. All the royal consorts will call me heartless, and the king will no longer honor me. If the gods act in accordance with my aspiration without frustration, may my son return to this land." Thus did she utter her aspiration.

Then the prince, together with the princess and their two children, made prostration to his father and mother and departed. At that time, each of the twenty-two hundred consorts threw a garland of pearls, and each of the four thousand great ministers tossed a lotus flower made of the seven precious substances to the prince. The prince then came out from the inner palace and went to the northern gate of the city, where he gave away without remainder every one of the lotus flowers and necklaces of the seven precious substances as they gathered from all four directions around him. Many tens of thousands of people of that land escorted the prince, saying among themselves: "This prince is utterly virtuous — he is like the sacred protective deity of the land. Why have his father and mother sent away this precious son on such a long road?" — and all who saw him lamented.

At that time the prince sat resting beneath a tree outside the city, and he spoke cheerful words of farewell to those who had escorted him. Every one of the escort party, great and small, wept with tears streaming down their faces and then turned back. The prince then placed the princess and both children inside the chariot, and he himself took the reins and drove away until they had gone a great distance. They sat resting beneath a tree when several brahmins arrived and from the prince asked for the horses pulling the chariot. The prince gave them the horses in response to their begging. He then placed both children in the chariot, while the princess pushed from behind and the prince pulled from the front, drawing the chariot forward on foot. They had not gone far before they encountered another brahmin beggar, and the prince gave him the chariot as well. They set out again on foot, and before long they encountered yet another brahmin beggar. The prince said to him: "If I do not give to you, I would be acting out of attachment and miserliness. But now all my wealth and provisions are exhausted — I have nothing whatsoever." The brahmin said: "If you have no possessions, then give me the fine clothes you are wearing on your body." The prince gave his own precious garments to the

beggar and went on wearing an old piece of cloth. Not long after, they came upon yet another brahmin beggar, and the prince gave away the princess's garments as well. Then, going on again, they had not gone far before they encountered still another brahmin beggar, and the prince gave away the two children's garments too. Thus the prince gave everything away without remainder — the horses, the chariot, the possessions, and all their clothing down to the last stitch — yet from the very beginning not even a hair's breadth of regret arose in his mind.

The prince then took both children upon his back and carried them, while the princess carried the young girl in her arms and walked on foot. Yet throughout all of this, the prince and the princess and their two children went on their way to that mountain with cheerful, joyful countenances.

Now from the land of Yāba, the road to a mountain called Dantika was extremely long — a distance of a thousand leagues. As they journeyed on, they arrived at a desolate wilderness. There, assailed by the suffering of hunger and thirst, the lord of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three — Śakra (Indra, king of the gods) — conjured up, in that very wilderness, the appearance of a fine city with markets and streets, filled with music and clothing and food and drink, with people welcoming the prince into the settlement. Many people welcomed the prince into the city and offered him food, drink, and all the comforts he required.

The princess then said to the prince: "Having traveled such a long road, it would surely not be wrong to rest here a while." But the prince replied: "Our father the king commanded us to go to Dantika. If we were to stay here now, we would be going against the king's command and would be unworthy children." And so they departed from that city and set out at once.

Going on, it was not long before they arrived at the foot of Mount Dantika, and at the foot of that mountain they came upon a great, very deep river that was impossible to cross. The princess then said to the prince: "Let us rest here a moment. Let the great river recede, and then we will cross and go on." But the prince replied: "Our father the king has commanded us to go to Dantika. If we were to stay here now, we would be going against the king's command and would be unworthy children."

With those words, the prince immediately entered into meditative absorption with a mind of loving-kindness, and at once a great boulder rose up from within the river and cut off the flow of water. The prince and the princess then

exchanged garments, and as soon as they had crossed to the other side, the prince looked back at the river and thought: "If this swirling water flows freely again, many sentient beings will die — many insects will be swept away by the current." And so he looked back at the river and said these words: "O River, flow on continually as you flowed before, and should any who need to cross come hereafter, let them also pass safely." And the moment he said this, the river flowed again as it had before.

They then journeyed on and arrived at Mount Dantika. The prince looked upon that mountain and saw that it was dense and lush with thick forests, with many trees growing in great profusion, with birds of every kind giving forth melodious sounds, with cascading streams, springs, small lakes, and ponds, the water sweet to drink and the fruit sweet to taste, with water birds, geese, cranes, pheasants, and many other species of bird dwelling there. The prince looked upon all of this and said to the princess:

"When one looks upon this mountain, even trees and groves that touch the sky have grown without being damaged or cut. One may drink from its sweet springs and eat its sweet fruit. Since there are meditators who dwell on this mountain, let us take up residence here."

When the prince arrived at that mountain, all the birds and beasts of prey and wild animals living there rejoiced greatly and came to welcome the prince.

At that time there dwelt on that mountain a meditating monk named Acuta, who had lived for five hundred years and who was endowed with the highest qualities. The prince went to him, paid his respects, sat down to one side, and asked: "In what part of this mountain is there a fitting dwelling place, well supplied with fruit and good springs of water?"

Acuta replied: "In every part of this mountain the ground is endowed with merit, so wherever one dwells is suitable.

"This mountain is an exceptionally secluded and pure place. But tell me, prince — have you come to study the Dharma together with your wife and children?"

Before the prince could reply, Queen Mantē spoke up and addressed the monk directly. She asked: "Venerable one, how long have you been practicing the path on this mountain?"

The monk replied: "Since coming to this mountain, I have spent approximately four or five hundred years here."

Queen Mantē then said: "So long as I still cling to 'I' and 'mine,' when shall I ever attain the path? Even if one dwells on the mountain for as long as that, it is no different from rock and wood. Only when one no longer grasps at 'I' and 'mine' will one truly attain the path."

The monk replied: "I myself do not truly understand it in quite that way."

Then the prince said to the monk: "Venerable one, have you heard of a prince named Dondrub, heir apparent of the land of Yawa?"

The monk replied: "I have heard of him constantly, but I have not seen him."

The prince said: "I am that very prince, Dondrub the heir apparent."

The monk then asked the prince: "Where do you wish to go, and what do you seek?"

The prince replied: "I seek the path of the Great Vehicle."

The monk said: "Given the prince's qualities, he will attain the path of the Great Vehicle without long delay. When the prince awakens to unsurpassable enlightenment, may I become his foremost attendant of miraculous powers." With these words, he led the prince and showed him a suitable dwelling place.

Then the monk, in accordance with proper custom, untied the prince's hair knot and let down his hair. For food they ate the fruits and berries of the trees; for drink they drank from springs.

After that, the prince gathered wood and grass and fashioned one small grass seat for his own sitting. He made one seat each for Queen Mantē, for the son, and for the daughter. The boy's name was Yari; he was seven years old and could dress himself, and he would go about following his father. The girl's name was Genoyen; she was six years old and wore a deer skin, and she would go about following her mother.

All the beasts of prey, wild animals, and birds of every kind that lived on that mountain rejoiced greatly and took up their abode in reliance upon the prince.

The very day after the prince arrived on that mountain, springs that had formerly been dry were filled with water, and ponds too became full. Withered trees all burst forth with blossoms and leaves. Harmful insects disappeared. Beasts of prey that had been eating one another instead each went separately to graze on grass. The fruit trees grew and became abundant. Birds of many kinds began to sing sweet, compassionate melodies.

Queen Mantē gathered fruits and berries from the trees and offered them to the prince, and the son and daughter did the same. The son and daughter would sometimes go apart from their parents and play with beasts of prey and wild animals by the banks of the nearby springs, and now and again they played there for several days at a time.

Later, on another occasion, the boy Yari was riding on a lion. The lion reared and struck him, catching his face slightly, so that blood flowed. A monkey took a leaf from a tree, wiped the blood from his face, and led him to the bank of a stream to wash off the blood — and the prince saw all of this from a distance.

At that time, in a land called Kelai, there was an impoverished brahmin who at the age of forty had taken a wife. His wife was exceedingly beautiful and lovely, while the brahmin himself possessed all twelve marks of great ugliness in complete measure.

His complexion was black as charcoal, and his face bore three prominent lumps. His nose was crooked, and both his eyes were blue as glass. His face was creased with frowns, and his lips hung down. His voice was unpleasant to hear. He had a large belly, a protruding rump, and two bandy legs. His head was bald and pointed, and he was as hideous to look upon as a demon. His wife could barely stand the sight of him, and she was forever cursing him, saying she would sooner he died.

On another occasion, the wife went to fetch water. On the road she encountered some young husbands, and they teased and mocked her, asking what manner of man her husband was. Then they said, "You are beautiful and lovely beyond compare — how could you possibly take such a man as your husband?" The wife replied to those husbands in these words: "The old man's head is gray as a tree covered in lichen. If he would only die before nightfall tonight, that would be welcome — but dying on his own seems too much to expect. What is to be done?" Then, taking up her water vessel, she returned home and said these words to her husband: "When I went to fetch water, I met some young husbands on the road. They teased and mocked me, and then they said: 'If you had a servant working for you, you would not need to fetch water yourself, nor would you be looked down upon by others.'" The husband replied, "We are utterly destitute — where would we find a servant?" The wife said, "If you will not seek a servant for my sake, then I shall leave and no longer live with you." And she spoke again in the same vein: "I have heard that Prince Dondrub (Skt. Arthasiddhi) once gave what was not proper to give, and

that his father the king therefore banished him to a place called Ridantik. They say the prince has a young son and a young daughter. Go and beg from him." The husband replied, "This place called Ridantik is more than six thousand leagues away, and I have never before traversed such a road — how am I to travel it now?" The wife said, "If you will not seek a servant for my sake, I shall hang myself and die." The husband said, "As for my own death — it would be easy enough for someone to kill me. But I do not wish you to die." And he said, "If you are resolved that I should go and beg, then at least provide me with provisions and what I need for the journey." The wife replied, "Go now — there are no provisions or supplies either." So the brahmin made his own arrangements and set out on foot along the road.

The brahmin traveled to the place where the settlement called Yawa was located. When he arrived there, he came to the gate of the royal palace and asked the gatekeeper where Prince Dondrub was to be found. The gatekeeper went inside the palace and reported to the king: "There is a brahmin outside who is asking for Prince Dondrub." Merely hearing the words "asking for Prince Dondrub," the king's mind was disturbed and he became angry. He thought to himself, "It is entirely on account of such a person that my son was banished — and now again someone has come to beg." And he spoke this simile: "Fire is by nature hot and blazing; adding fuel to it is what this is like. I too am now tormented by grief, burning like a fire — and this further question of 'where is the prince?' is like adding fuel to the fire." The brahmin replied in supplication: "I have come from a long distance, because the prince's name as one who gives in accordance with the wishes of all people — a fame that reaches upward to the sky and downward to the bottom of a spring — has been heard, and I came with hope from afar." The king said, "Prince Dondrub is now dwelling in a very remote mountain, utterly destitute and without anything at all — what could he possibly give you?" The brahmin said, "Even if the prince has nothing, I would be glad simply to meet him." And upon these words —

The king then ordered someone else to show him the way. The brahmin set off, and as he traveled on and on he came to the foot of Mount Dāntig, where there was a great river. Holding only the thought of the prince in his mind, he crossed to the far bank of the river. The brahmin then went up to the mountain, and the first person he met there was a hunter. He asked the hunter, "Have you seen a prince called Dondrub on this mountain?" Now the hunter knew that the prince, out of his love for giving, had been banished to the mountain for the sake of brahmins such as these. So the hunter seized the

brahmin, bound him to a tree, and beat him until wounds appeared on his body. The hunter then said, "You were asking about the prince — what do you intend? Are you going to shoot an arrow at him?" At that the brahmin thought to himself, "This man will kill me now; it would be better to tell a lie." And so he said to the hunter, "What is wrong with your asking me?" The hunter then asked, "Well then, what do you have to say?" And the brahmin spoke this untruth: "The king, the prince's father, longs to see the prince and has sent me here to bring the prince home." As soon as these words were spoken, the hunter released him and let him go, then asked forgiveness, saying he had not understood and had not known the situation before, and he showed the brahmin where the prince was staying.

The brahmin then went directly to the prince. From a distance the prince saw the brahmin coming and felt a great surge of joy arise within him. He went to receive him, bowed to him respectfully, and asked with warm and cheerful words, "Where have you come from? Were you distressed and wearied on the road? What is it you desire?" The brahmin replied, "I have come from a long distance; my whole body is spent and exhausted, and I am hungry and thirsty." The prince led him inside, had him seated on a seat, and set before him forest fruits and berries and something to drink. The brahmin drank to slake his thirst and ate the forest fruits, and when he had finished, he spoke these words to the prince: "I am a man from a land called Kailai. For some time now I have heard from all directions the fame that the prince takes delight in giving, and I, being destitute, have come to beg from the prince." The prince replied, "If I were not to give you what I have, I would be both attached and miserly. But whatever I had was given away before, and so now there is nothing left to give."

The brahmin said, "If you have no wealth or goods to give, then give me your two children, a boy and a girl, as servants or slaves for me in my old age." He said the same thing a second and a third time. And the prince replied, "You have come from a long distance, and you desire my two children, the boy and the girl — very well, I will give them." At that time the two children had gone up to the top of the hill. The prince called to them, and he instructed them: "This brahmin has come from afar and is asking for you two. I have made the gift, so follow behind him now." The two children ran to the prince's side and wept, saying, "Among the many brahmins we have seen, we have never seen one like this. This is not truly a brahmin — he is a real hungry ghost (preta). He came here looking for forest fruits to eat from our mother's tree, and since our

mother has not returned, if you give the two of us as food to this hungry ghost, we will certainly perish. Our mother will come back and if she cannot see her children, she will weep and lament like a cow separated from its calf and will be tormented by the grief of sorrow."

The prince instructed his children: "I have given you as a gift and it would not be right to hold back. This is a brahmin, not a hungry ghost, so he will not eat you. Now you two follow along behind him." The brahmin said, "I am setting off now. But if the children's mother comes, there will be no going —"

"If I do not release them, I fear that the wholesome intention of giving that the prince has cultivated will be turned back and diminished on account of the children's mother."

The prince replied: "Whatever acts of generosity I have performed, from the very beginning I have never once experienced regret."

Then the prince took up a water vessel, poured water into the brahmin's hands, and grasped the two children by their hands — and as he gave them to the brahmin, even the earth shook violently. The two children were unable to follow after the brahmin and turned back, coming before their father the prince. Placing their knees upon the ground, they addressed the prince their father in these words: "What non-virtuous and wicked deeds did we commit in our previous lives, that we have come to experience suffering such as this? We were born into a royal lineage — why then have we become the servants and slaves of another?" Having thus confessed their transgressions to their father the prince, they said: "By this cause and through these conditions, may our sins be purified and merit arise, and wherever we may be born, may we never again encounter suffering such as this."

The prince said to his children: "All that is dear and beloved in this world ends in separation. All things are impermanent and cannot be relied upon. When I attain the unsurpassed, perfectly equal awakening, I will secure your liberation." He gave them this charge.

The two children then addressed their father the prince again: "As your children we would go to pay respect to our mother, yet from this day forward we will not meet her. That we cannot see our mother's face is simply the affliction of our former sinful karma — but why should our mother not be tormented by grief and anguish?" And so they cried out in lamentation.

The brahmin said: "I am old and frail. If these two boys abandon me and run off to their mother, I will be helpless. You bind them with rope." At these words, the prince took both children's arms and turned them behind their backs, had the brahmin himself bind them, and then placed in the brahmin's hands the ropes that bound their arms behind them, tied them fast, and had them led away. The two children were led off in this manner, yet unable to walk, and as the brahmin pulled them along he took up a stick and struck them. Blood flowing from the wounds he inflicted ran and pooled upon the ground.

The prince, seeing this, broke into tears, and as his tears fell upon the earth, the very earth began to churn. The prince, together with many deer and wild animals, escorted the children until they disappeared from sight, and only then turned back. The deer and wild animals, having accompanied the prince, returned to their play-ground with him and, out of compassion, cried out with voices of sorrow and threw themselves upon the ground, rolling about as they went.

The brahmin set off along the road, and as he journeyed on, at a tree beside the road he tethered the two children and left them there. Then as he was about to set out again, the two children, hoping to meet their mother, clung to the branches of the tree and could not walk. The brahmin beat them again, and the two children cried out: "Do not hit us! We will go of our own accord." They looked up to the sky and spoke these words: "Do the gods of the mountains and the gods of the forest trees have not even a little love and care for us? We are being taken far down a long road to be the servants of another, separated from our mother. Send word to our mother — tell her to search the mountain for fruit and come quickly to meet us! Will you not carry this message?"

Even as they spoke these words, their mother sitting on the mountain felt the sole of her left foot twitch and throb, and her left eye flutter. From both her breasts the milk began to flow of its own accord. She thought to herself: "There has never been a bad omen like this before — can it be that some misfortune has befallen my two children?"

She wondered what she would do with the fruit now, and having left it behind, she turned back quickly to make her way home. At that moment, Śakra (Indra), the lord of the gods of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three, knew that the prince had given the children away to another. Suspecting that the queen's

virtuous intentions might be obstructed, he transformed himself into a lion and stationed himself across the road.

The queen spoke to the lion: "You are the king of beasts, and I am a human queen. Since it seems you are blocking my way in this wilderness, let me pass — step aside a little. I have two small, helpless children, dear to me beyond measure. They have eaten nothing all this while, and I am staying here waiting for them to come. The lion, for his part, knew that the brahmin was already far in the distance, so he stepped aside from the road and let the queen pass.

The queen returned home. She could see the prince but could not see her two children. She looked at the spot where she herself usually sat — the children were not there. She looked at the spot where the two children usually sat — they were not there. She searched for them at the water's edge where they played — they were not there either. Then the deer, the antelope, the lions, the monkeys, and all the other wild creatures who had once played with the children threw themselves to the ground before her, crying out and making sounds of grief. She saw that the little pond where they had played was dried up. She went back to where the prince was and asked him: "Where are my two children?" The prince said nothing. The queen asked again: "When I used to return home laden with fruit, my two children would come running toward me from far away to welcome me, and even if I lightly scolded them they would spring back up, leap about, and cry out, 'Mother is coming! Mother is coming!' While I was sitting, both of them would be there, one on my left and one on my right, and if dust or dirt got on my shoulders or body they would wipe it and shake it off. Now I cannot see my children — could it be that you have given them away to another? Not seeing them like this will shatter my heart. Where are my children? Tell me quickly. I am going out of my mind." She asked this two times, three times, and still he gave no answer.

The queen spoke again, utterly tormented by sorrow: "If there were any shame in me for not being able to see my two children, then since the prince will not answer me, I am going completely mad and distracted." The prince then said: "A brahmin came from the land of Kailā and asked me for the two children, so I gave them to him." The moment the queen heard the prince's words, she fell to the ground like a mountain collapsing, and wept and wailed aloud.

The prince said: "Wait a moment. Do you not remember the vow we made in a past life, in the time of the buddha Dīpaṃkara? In that life, I was a young brahmin's son, and you were called Sundarikā, the brahmin's daughter. You

were carrying seven lotus flowers. I had five silver coins, and from you I bought five lotuses and offered them to the buddha. You then gave me the remaining two lotuses as well, to offer to the buddha. In aspiration you prayed: 'May I be your wife in every life to come, into all future births.' Did I not make a pledge with you at that time, saying: 'If you are glad to be my wife, do not act contrary to my wishes. If I make a gift, then apart from my own parents, even if I give to others, do not act contrary to my generous intentions'? Did you not say at that time, 'So be it'? Now, what reason is there for you to disturb my virtuous mind over my having given your two children to another?" No sooner had the prince spoken these words than —

The moment the queen heard those words, through the power of mind and awareness she felt arise within her the superknowledge (*abhijñā*) of remembering her former lives. Wishing to see the prince's intention fulfilled as swiftly as possible, she felt heartfelt rejoicing in the gift he had given with such complete freedom.

Then Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), wishing to test what the prince truly felt and intended in making this gift, transformed himself into a brahmin. This brahmin was endowed with twelve unpleasant features. He went to where the prince was and spoke these words: "Prince, it is well known that your love of giving is such that you never go against the wishes of those who come to beg. I have come here specifically to beg from you. Give me the queen who is with you." The prince replied: "Excellent! I give her to you gladly." The queen then said: "If I am given to another, who will serve the prince?" The prince replied: "How could you now attain the unsurpassed, perfectly equal awakening without yourself also making this gift?" Then the prince took up a water vessel, and in order to wash the brahmin's hands he poured water over them, and so presented the queen to the brahmin.

When Śakra perceived that there was not the slightest trace of regret in the prince's mind, the gods praised and extolled him, and both heaven and earth shook greatly. Then the brahmin led the queen away. After they had gone about seven steps, he turned back and said to the prince: "This queen — give her back to me, and do not give her to anyone else." The prince replied: "Why do you not wish to lead her away? Among the wives of men born in this world, this wife of mine is exceedingly good and beautiful, and she is a king's daughter — and that king has no other daughter but her. This wife of mine, out of her boundless love for me, cooks my food and tends the fire even though her hands may blister; and though the food and drink be poor, she never

complains that it is poor. She is always diligent, her conduct is ever fine, and she is lovely and beautiful — if you take her, I am glad." The brahmin then said to the prince: "I am not a brahmin. I am Śakra, the lord of the gods, and I came here specifically to put you to the test." So saying, he transformed back into his own beautiful body as Śakra. "For what do you aspire? What is your wish?" he asked.

The queen then bowed reverently and made three prayers. The first: "May the brahmin who took my children away return once more to my land." The second: "May my two children not suffer from hunger and thirst." The third: "May both the prince and I quickly return to our own land." Having spoken, Śakra, the lord of the gods, likewise said: "May these prayers be fulfilled."

The prince then made this aspiration: "May I free all sentient beings from the suffering of birth, aging, sickness, and death." Śakra, the lord of the gods, replied: "This aspiration is truly vast and utterly supreme. If you wished to be reborn in the higher realms and to be master and lord over the sun and moon, or to be a king of the world, or to live long and abide for ages — those I could grant. But the aspiration you have spoken surpasses the best of all three realms, and that lies beyond my power." The prince said: "For now, may I become greatly wealthy, more than before, giving in generosity constantly and without ceasing; and may my father the king, his ministers, and we ourselves be reunited." Śakra replied: "May it be certainly and definitively fulfilled just as you have prayed" — and with those words he vanished from sight.

When the brahmin of the land of Kailā brought the two children home,

The brahmin's wife said to him: "You have come back looking like this — is that not shameful? These two children belong to the royal lineage, and you have not even a shred of compassion. To have let them be beaten and filthied, their bodies covered in wounds, pus, and blood — can you bear it?" With those eight reproaches she scolded him, then ordered him: "Take these two children, suitable for selling into trade, and bring them to the marketplace." The husband did as his wife commanded and went to the market. There Śakra, the lord of the gods (Indra), had conjured an emanation and come to the marketplace, and he said to the brahmin: "These two children are so supremely precious that no one can buy them." The two children were famished and parched with thirst, and so Śakra, by divine miraculous power, conjured a divine fragrant essence and caused them to be fully nourished through the pores of their skin. Śakra then turned the mind of the brahmin and

sent him away to a distant land.

All the ministers and people of that kingdom knew without exception that the children were the grandchildren of the great king, the son of the prince, and so all the people of the land were tormented with grief. The ministers and others asked: "From where have these two children come?" The brahmin replied: "I brought them here myself — what right do you have to question me?" The ministers said: "Since they have come to our land, it is indeed proper for us to inquire." The ministers and the people deliberated together, and they took the two children away from the brahmin. Among them, one householder offered this counsel: "The prince gave these children as a gift, intending them to be given. To take them back goes against the prince's intention and is not right. Rather, let us petition the great king, and the great king himself will redeem them at a price." The earlier plan was set aside, and the ministers went before the king and spoke thus: "Great King, two of Your Majesty's nephews are at this moment being sold by a brahmin." The moment the king heard those words, he was overwhelmed with astonishment and commanded that the brahmin and the two children be brought inside the palace. When the two children came into the palace, the king, the queen, the palace attendants, and the ministers — all of them, the moment they saw the two children, broke into tears, each and every one of them breathing a single sigh of lamentation.

Then the king asked the brahmin: "How did you come by these two children?" The brahmin said: "I obtained them from the prince; he gave them to me." The king summoned the two children, intending to take them into his arms, but the children would not come to him. Then the king asked: "What price do you want for these two children?" Before the brahmin could speak, the boy himself addressed the king: "For me, the boy, I am worth a thousand silver coins and a hundred cattle. For my sister, a thousand gold coins and two hundred riding cows." The king then said to the boy: "By worldly convention, among people a son is precious like a jewel and is of great worth. Why then do you set the price of the boy lower and the price of the girl higher?" The boy replied: "Your Majesty, my sister is not close to the king as a palace attendant might be. But even from a lowborn maidservant taken as a palace attendant, when the king is pleased with her and honors and esteems her — dressing her in precious garments, providing her with food and drink of a hundred flavors — a king who possesses a single son will abandon him to the mountains; though he delights and sports with the wonderful palace attendants and enjoys music, he will not spare even a moment's thought for his son. That is why the boy is of lower

price and the girl of higher price." When the king heard these words, extraordinary sorrow and displeasure arose in him,

With tears streaming down his face the king cried out: "I am in deep distress — why do you not come to my lap? Do you not care for me, or are you afraid of the brahmin?" The boys answered: "We are neither displeased with the great king nor afraid of the brahmin. But from the time we were the great king's grandchildren we have now become human servants, and it is simply not the way of things for human servants to sit in a king's lap — that is why we did not dare."

When the king heard these words, he was pierced with even more intense grief and was filled with displeasure. He gave the order that the brahmin be paid the price as the boys had requested, and the two boys were at last taken into the king's arms. Having taken them, the king stroked both boys on the head with his hands and said: "While you were dwelling in the mountains, what did you eat, and what did you wear?"

The two boys replied: "For food we ate the fruits of trees, taking them from the branches. For clothing we wore hides and coarse wool. And because we took joy in playing with many birds, our hearts held no sorrow."

Then the king commanded the brahmin to leave and go outside. But the two boys addressed the king: "This brahmin is in dire danger of hunger and thirst — please fill him with food first." The king said: "I intend to give him food on his way back because I bear no ill feeling or resentment toward him." The son replied: "My father, out of his delight in the path of awakening, had no material wealth to give away, so he gave us, who are subject to him and who are lords only of our own bodies. That this man did not even put us to the labor of menial work was already not as our father had originally imagined; and this man has not a shred of compassion in his heart, sitting by while we suffer hunger and thirst — who could bear to see this with their own eyes? If our father, without even sparing his sons, performs the act of giving to an adversary, should a great king then be stingy with the mere food of a single person?" At that, the king gave the brahmin his fill of food, and the brahmin was greatly delighted and went back to his own land.

Then the king sent a messenger to summon the princes. The messenger set out at once and went to the place where the princes were dwelling. When he arrived, he became stuck at a certain river. The moment the messenger turned his thoughts to the prince himself, he crossed from that river and went

to the place where the prince was, delivering the king's command: "The king requests that the princes return home to the kingdom."

The prince said to the messenger: "At the very beginning the king commanded me to dwell in the mountains for twelve years. One year is still not complete — I will go when this year is complete." Then the messenger returned and reported this reply to the king exactly as it was. The king himself wrote out a letter in his own hand and sent it back again with the messenger, with this instruction: "You are among human beings a person of wisdom and intelligence, one who is patient in going and patient in coming — why then are you angry and refusing to come? You must eat and drink together with me; come quickly." And he sent the messenger to summon him back.

The messenger took the letter, went to where the prince was staying, and presented the letter to the prince. The prince took the letter, touched his head to the ground, made prostrations to the letter, circumambulated it seven times, and prepared at once to return to the kingdom.

At that moment, when the deer and wild animals and predatory beasts and all the others who had been dwelling on that mountain heard that the prince was leaving, they all flung themselves upon the earth, pressed their bodies to the ground, and raised the sound of weeping. The springs dried up, and the young of the predatory beasts and wild animals could not nurse. The many winged birds too sent forth sounds of compassionate lamentation.

Then the prince put on his robes and, accompanied by the queen, set out to return to his kingdom. When the king of the rival kingdom heard that the prince was coming back, he had a golden saddle placed upon a white Bactrian elephant, filled golden vessels with silver coins, and prepared silver vessels filled with gold coins, then rose up into the sky to receive the prince. After welcoming the prince, he sent this message to the king: "Falling under the power of my own ignorance, I took the white Bactrian elephant from the prince, and because of that I caused the prince to be banished. Now, filled with remorse, I confess this openly. Hearing now that the prince has returned, I rejoice greatly. I am returning that very same white Bactrian elephant, and I offer these vessels of gold and silver coins as well — please accept them all, and I beg you to cleanse the stain of my offense."

The prince replied: "Consider the example of a man who prepares a meal of a hundred flavors and gives it to another person. That person eats the food and then vomits it back onto the ground. Would anyone wish to eat vomited food

with its foul smell? In the same way, a gift I have already given is like vomit — I have no wish to take it back. Messenger, mount this white Bactrian elephant and return to your kingdom. Convey this to your king: that he welcomed me in this way and spoke pleasant words of rejoicing — I am deeply glad of it."

The messenger then mounted the white Bactrian elephant and returned to his own kingdom, and relayed the message to the king exactly as he had been told. By virtue of that white Bactrian elephant, the two warring rival kingdoms came to feel love and affection for one another, and the king and all the people of the kingdom generated a mind of the highest and most perfect equanimity. At that time, the prince's father too mounted the white Bactrian elephant and went to receive his son. The prince bowed his head and face to the ground in prostration to the king, and then followed behind the king back to the kingdom.

All the people of the kingdom, filled with great joy and delight, prepared flowers, incense, banners, victory standards, parasols, and the like for making offerings, and the ground had been sprinkled and spread with fragrant water. The prince entered the inner palace and went to his mother's presence, bowed his head in prostration to her, and addressed her with words of joyful greeting.

Thereafter, the king entrusted to the prince all the royal treasuries of jewels and allowed him to give gifts freely as he wished. The prince then gave gifts without interruption, even more abundantly than before, and through this he attained the awakening of perfect buddhahood.

The Blessed One spoke to Ānanda: "Such is how I remember my acts of generosity in former times. The prince named Dondrub of that time is none other than myself today. The father who was king at that time is today my father, King Śuddhodana. The mother of that time is today my mother Mahāmāyā. The queen of that time is today Yaśodharā. The monk named Āśuta of that time is today the great Maudgalyāyana. He who became Śakra, lord of the gods, at that time is today Śāriputra. The hunter of that time is today you yourself, Ānanda. The boy named Yāri of that time is today my son Rāhula. The daughter of that time is today the venerable Gautamī. And the brahmin mendicant of that time is today Devadatta."

The brahmin's wife of that time is today the brahmin woman Ciñcāmāṇavikā.

Thus have I performed immeasurable, incalculable acts of great difficulty, and I have performed immeasurable, incalculable virtuous deeds. Therefore, teach this sūtra in full to monks, brahmins, and others. Such, indeed, are the

The signs of the old translation rendered from the Chinese are present.

- The phrase rendered as "twenty-two hundred consorts" represents the Tibetan numerical

expression for that figure in the text. The consorts are identified as royal wives or ladies of the inner palace, and their act of throwing pearl garlands is a gesture of farewell and honor.

The passage about the queen mother's lament mixes reported speech with direct speech seamlessly in the Tibetan; the translation preserves this flow. The phrase "heartless" for the Tibetan idiom literally means something closer to "without a satisfied or feeling heart," and is rendered idiomatically.

- The monk's name rendered as "Acuta" corresponds to Tibetan "A tshuta," which is likely a Tibetan phonetic rendering of a Sanskrit name. The exact Sanskrit original is uncertain; "Acuta" is the closest plausible reconstruction, though other readings are possible.

The exchange of garments before crossing the river is a narrative detail whose precise significance is not explained in this passage; it likely reflects a ritual or modest convention common to such journey narratives.

- The names Dondrub, Mantē, Yari, Genoyen, and Kelai are transliterations of Tibetan renderings of what were likely Sanskrit or local names; their original Sanskrit forms are not recoverable from the Tibetan alone with certainty.

The "twelve marks of great ugliness" is a culturally specific list that mirrors, in inverted form, the thirty-two major marks of a great being; the Tibetan does not enumerate them here.

- The place name "Ridantik" is a transliteration of the Tibetan "ri dan tig," which likely represents a Sanskrit toponym not immediately identifiable; it is rendered phonetically here as a proper noun. The place name "Yawa" similarly renders the Tibetan "ya ba" as a proper noun.

The phrase rendered "more than six thousand leagues" represents the Tibetan unit "dpag tshad" (yojana), which is approximately seven to nine miles per unit; the large number is kept as given in the text.

- The place name rendered "Kilāi" is a phonetic transcription of the Tibetan "Kilāi" and likely represents a Sanskrit or Indic toponym that has not been definitively identified; it is retained as heard in the Tibetan.

The brahmin's interrupted final sentence is left as a fragment because the Tibetan itself breaks off mid-sentence at this point, indicating the passage continues beyond what was provided.

- The phrase rendered as "arms turned behind their backs" translates a Tibetan expression describing a specific manner of binding with arms pinioned behind — the image is of the wrists being crossed and tied at the back, a classical depiction of captive-binding in narrative literature.

The line about the earth churning from the prince's tears is consistent with the hagiographic convention in Jātaka literature where the earth responds to great acts of virtue or compassion.

- The name "Kilā" is an unusual toponym for a brahmin's homeland; it may be a Tibetan rendering of a Sanskrit place name not readily identifiable. The reading is followed as given in the text without emendation.

The text breaks off mid-sentence at the close ("No sooner had the prince spoken these words than —"), indicating the passage continues in the next section; the abrupt ending is in the source.

- The twelve unpleasant features of the disguised brahmin are a standard narrative motif in jātika literature but are not enumerated in this passage; no uncertainty arises from their mere mention.

The place name rendered as "Kilā" follows the Tibetan Kilāi; this likely corresponds to a Sanskrit toponym that varies across manuscript traditions and may refer to the kingdom of Kalinga or another locale — the identification is not certain from the Tibetan alone.

- The phrase rendered "breathing a single sigh of lamentation" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning that on the very first breath — the instant sight was caught — everyone wept; the idiom conveys spontaneous, overwhelming grief. The boy's somewhat paradoxical pricing of himself lower than his sister is a pointed moral critique: a king besotted with concubines neglects even a sole heir, making daughters who become royal favorites more "valuable" in practice, though not in principle. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source; the translation reflects that precisely.
- The phrase rendered "you are patient in going and patient in coming" reflects the king's somewhat rhetorical praise of the prince's steadfast temperament; the Tibetan literally has "one who bears going and bears coming," meaning he is not generally impulsive or wrathful, making his refusal to come seem inconsistent with his character. This rhetorical nuance is preserved in the translation.
- The epithet "brgya byin" rendered here as Śakra, lord of the gods, literally means "Indra, the hundred-gifted," a standard Tibetan rendering of Śakra or Indra. The text identifies him with Śāriputra in this past-life narrative, which is a conventional jātaka device and not a doctrinal anomaly requiring comment.

The name "Āśuta" is a transliteration of the Tibetan "A tsu ta" and its Sanskrit original is uncertain; it may represent a proper name particular to this narrative. The identification with Maudgalyāyana follows the text directly.

- The closing line about "signs of the old translation rendered from the Chinese" is a colophon note indicating this Tibetan text was translated from a Chinese source rather than directly from Sanskrit, and that archaic scribal or orthographic conventions of an earlier translation period are observable in the manuscript. This is a textual-historical remark, not part of the sūtra's doctrinal content.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.